

Hackles Teacher Academy: Certificate and Badges

Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell.

Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell.

FIELD COPY

1



Lock It

PASSWORDS AND ACCOUNTS

2



Spot It

SCAMS AND FAKES

3



Share Smart

PRIVACY

4



Safe People

WHO TO TRUST

5



Kind and Well

KINDNESS AND BALANCE

6



Fix It

TELL, REPAIR, RECOVER

PLATE I. The six strands, hand-inked, in the order the lessons take them.

Hackles · a free kit · quillsup.org

© 2026 Competence Collective. Lesson text and teaching materials: CC BY-NC 4.0 (free to print, share and adapt for non-commercial use with credit). The Hackles name, logos, characters and artwork are not covered by that license: print and share them unaltered for classroom and family use; any other use needs written permission. [VERIFY with counsel]



OCTOBER 2026

Hackles · Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell. Hackles · a free kit · quillsup.org. © 2026 Competence Collective. Lesson text and teaching materials: CC BY-NC 4.0 (free to print, share and adapt for non-commercial use with credit). The Hackles name, logos, characters and artwork are not covered by that license: print and share them unaltered for classroom and family use; any other use needs written permission. [VERIFY with counsel]

No accounts, no tracking, no registry. These certificates are printed, signed and kept by you.

01 **What the certificate means (and does not mean)**

THE HACKLES-READY CERTIFICATE SAYS that a teacher has **completed the Hackles Teacher Academy and demonstrated, to a reviewer, the basic competencies for teaching online safety and responding to disclosures.**

It does **not** mean:

- that the holder is a licensed counselor, attorney or cybersecurity professional;
- that the holder is certified by any government, accrediting body or state education agency;
- that it counts for professional development (PD) credit or licensure renewal. Some schools or districts may choose to recognize it for PD hours: ask your administrator. [VERIFY with your district or state; no credit is guaranteed or implied.]

The certificate is issued on the honor system by a **reviewer** (principal, coach, counselor, mentor or learning buddy) and by the learner. The Hackles team does not maintain a certificate registry, and the certificate does not expire, although we recommend a yearly refresher (see Section 6).

02 **Levels at a glance**

LEVEL	WHO	WHAT YOU DO	TIME
Quick Start Completion Note	Teachers who need to start teaching soon	Quick Start pathway (90 min) and Mini-Check 4 of 5	About 90 minutes
Hackles-Ready	Teachers who completed the Full or Specialist pathway	Modules 1 to 8, micro-teach, First 10 Minutes role-play, capstone, surveys	About 10 hours including the capstone (Full) or about 8 hours (Specialist)
Hackles Mentor	Hackles-Ready teachers who help colleagues become ready	Coach two colleagues; reflect; reviewer sign-off	About 3 additional hours

03 Requirements by level

3.1 QUICK START COMPLETION NOTE

- ☐ Pre-Course Confidence Survey
- ☐ Module 1: "The short version" and the four Calm Facts
- ☐ Module 2: Activities 2.1 and 2.2
- ☐ Module 4: the five rules and the "Good vs weak" table
- ☐ Module 5: "Anatomy of a 15-minute lesson" and the Mini Micro-Teach (7 minutes)
- ☐ Module 6: the First 10 Minutes card, key phrases said aloud, and your Contact Card filled in
- ☐ Quick Start Mini-Check, 4 of 5 or better

What it means: "I am ready to start teaching Hackles lessons safely. I will complete the Full pathway."

3.2 HACKLES-READY CERTIFICATE

- ☐ Pre-Course Confidence Survey
- ☐ Modules 1 to 8 completed with a self-check score of 8 of 10 or better in each
- ☐ Micro-teach (Activity 5.3), observed, with a rubric total of 18 or more (peer or self-scored accepted) [or an agreed re-try]
- ☐ First 10 Minutes role-play (Activity 6.3) as the Teacher, with at least 9 of 11 checklist items (playing the Student is always optional)
- ☐ Contact Card complete and verified by an administrator or counselor
- ☐ Capstone (four pieces) reviewed and scored: at least five of six rows at "Hackles-Ready" or above, **no row at "Beginning," and Row E (Respond) at Hackles-Ready or above**
- ☐ Post-Course Confidence Survey
- ☐ Reviewer's signature

3.3 HACKLES MENTOR

To be a Hackles Mentor you must **hold Hackles-Ready**, then:

- ☐ Coach **two colleagues** through (a) a micro-teach with the rubric and (b) the First 10 Minutes role-play, including a debrief (two glows and a grow).
- ☐ Lead at least one **colleague teach-back** (Module 8, Part 5) or a short staff PD segment (15 to 30 minutes).
- ☐ Help at least one colleague fill in their Contact Card and find the local reporting steps.



- ☐ Write a **reflection (about 250 words)**: what you learned from mentoring, what was hard, and what you would do differently.
- ☐ Present **Mentor-level evidence** on the capstone rubric (at least four rows at 4) or a written note from a reviewer agreeing that you coach well.
- ☐ Agree to keep your **Hackles-Ready refresher** current and to help keep school-level reporting steps current.
- ☐ Reviewer's signature (a principal or district lead, if possible).

What it means: "I help others become ready, I keep our school's response steps alive, and I model calm, shame-free teaching."

3.4 SPECIALIST NOTE

Computing and IT teachers earn the same certificates through the Specialist pathway. They may list "Specialist pathway" on the certificate. The Specialist Corner activities in each module are recommended evidence for Mentor-level work, especially Module 6 (technical first responder without viewing images) and Module 8 (running PD).

04 Certificate text (print-ready)

COPY, PRINT, SIGN. A4 or letter. Add your own school logo if you like.

[Logo: Hackles]

SECTION

CERTIFICATE OF COMPLETION

1

Hackles Teacher Academy

HACKLES-READY

This certifies that

has completed the Hackles Teacher Academy, a self-paced course in teaching cybersecurity and online safety, and has shown the ability to:

- explain the real risks children face online in calm, accurate language;
- practice and teach basic cybersecurity;

- listen to young people's online lives with curiosity;
- teach short, active, shame-free safety lessons;
- respond to a child's disclosure with the First 10 Minutes and report as required;
- include every learner and every family; and
- measure, reflect, and keep growing.

Hackles up? Pause. Check. Tell.

Pathway completed (circle): Full · Specialist

Date: _____

Reviewer (name and role): _____

Reviewer's signature: _____

School or organization (optional): _____

The Hackles Teacher Academy is a free course at quillsup.org. © 2026 Competence Collective. Lesson text: CC BY-NC 4.0; the Hackles name, logos, characters and art are all rights reserved. This certificate is awarded on the honor system and is not a government or accreditation credential, and does not constitute legal or clinical qualification.

[Logo: Hackles]

SECTION

CERTIFICATE OF RECOGNITION

2

Hackles Teacher Academy

HACKLES MENTOR

This certifies that

holds the Hackles-Ready certificate and has coached colleagues to teach online safety and to respond to children with care. As a Hackles Mentor, they

2

- coached at least two colleagues through a micro-teach and a First 10 Minutes role-play;
- led a colleague teach-back or staff session; and
- helped keep their school's reporting steps clear and current.

Trust your hackles. Pause · Check · Tell.

Date: _____

Reviewer (name and role): _____

Reviewer's signature: _____

The Hackles Teacher Academy is a free course at quillsup.org. © 2026 Competence Collective. Lesson text: CC BY-NC 4.0; the Hackles name, logos, characters and art are all rights reserved. This recognition is awarded on the honor system and is not a government or accreditation credential.

[Logo: Hackles]

QUICK START COMPLETION NOTE

This note confirms that

has completed the Hackles Teacher Academy Quick Start (90 minutes) and is ready to begin teaching Hackles lessons, with a plan to complete the Full pathway.

Date: _____ Signed: _____

Quick Start is not the Hackles-Ready certificate.

05 Badges (for fun, and for motivation)

OPTIONAL RECOGNITIONS THAT YOU can print, cut out, post on your door, or award to each other. Small, silly and sincere. They are **not** credentials. They are for celebration.

BADGE	AWARDED FOR	ICON IDEA
First Spike	Completing Module 1	One small orange spike
Lock Picker (the good kind)	Completing Module 2 and turning on 2-step verification	A key with a smile
Anthropologist	Completing Module 3 and having a curiosity conversation	A magnifying glass
Skill Builder	Completing Module 4 and rewriting a fear lesson	A hammer and a spike
Fifteen-Minute Wonder	Completing a micro-teach in 15 minutes (plus or minus one)	An hourglass
Steady Voice	Completing the First 10 Minutes role-play	A calm wave
Open Door	Completing Module 7 and making one lesson more inclusive	A door ajar
Glow and Grow	Completing the capstone	A plant with a sun
Debrief Buddy	Agreeing to be someone's check-in partner	Two linked hands
False Alarm Champion	Celebrating a student's false alarm in class	A spike with a thumbs up
The Spiral	Teaching a Hackles check-in in a month after the lessons	A spiral
Hackles Mentor	See Section 3.3	A larger spike with a lantern

Badge rules: award yourself, or let a friend do it. There is no list of who earned what. Everyone is welcome to make up new badges.

HACKLES-STYLE BADGE FOR STUDENTS (NOT PART OF THE ACADEMY)

Student-facing materials never carry marketing, accounts or tracking. If you create a classroom badge for students, keep it kind, non-competitive and not tied to personal data: for example, "Hackles Helper." Do not rank children. Do not publish names without family consent. [VERIFY your school's policy]

3

06 Keeping your certificate current

THE APPS WILL CHANGE. The routine will not. But the details around it will. We suggest a **yearly refresher** (about 45 minutes) that does the following:

- ☐ Re-read the Disclosure and Incident Guide's First 10 Minutes card.
- ☐ Update your Contact Card (names, numbers, any policy changes). [VERIFY]
- ☐ Re-do the Module 2 settings stroll.
- ☐ Glance at the current statistics and [VERIFY] flags in Module 1.
- ☐ Do one micro-teach with a colleague.
- ☐ Read two recent updates from a trusted source (for example, a platform change or a new law). [VERIFY]
- ☐ Review the self-care plan in Module 6.

Mark the date on your certificate: "Refreshed: _____."

07 Certificate checklist for reviewers and administrators

IF YOU ARE SIGNING, you are saying "this person has done the work." Before you sign, confirm:

- ☐ The learner has done all required items for the level.
- ☐ The Contact Card matches your school's actual procedures.
- ☐ You have heard them say the three sentences aloud (Hackles-Ready).
- ☐ No real student information is in the capstone.
- ☐ You have written two glows and one grow.

08 Using the certificate in your school

- **Staff recognition:** celebrate at a meeting; share the Hackles routine on a bulletin board.
- **Onboarding:** ask new teachers to complete Quick Start in their first month and Hackles-Ready in their first year.

- **Directory:** if you want a list of Hackles-Ready teachers, keep it to name, date and level, and share only inside the school, with consent. [VERIFY your district's policy]
- **Families:** you may say that teachers have completed "a free teacher training on teaching online safety," without implying accreditation.
- **PD credit:** talk with your administrator about whether your district might recognize Academy time. [VERIFY. No credit is promised.]

This document is educational guidance, not legal advice.